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Running for office? Open your wallet.

Prominent statewide GOP candidates are pouring millions into own campaigns

By Samantha J. Gross
GLOBE STAFF

The leading Republican contenders for Massachusetts' top offices this year are collectively pouring millions of their own money into their campaigns, hoping it will give them a shot at besting the state's dominant Democrats.

As the state GOP continues to struggle financially and at the ballot box, self-funding has practically become a prerequisite for Republicans

LEADING GOP CANDIDATES' CONTRIBUTIONS TO THEIR GUBERNATORIAL CAMPAIGNS

Mike Minogue:
\$5.5M

Mike Kennealy:
\$1.8M

Brian Shortleeve:
\$200K

running for the state's highest offices. It's a symptom of an embattled party unable to offer candidates much support and a reminder that money talks.

Among the gubernatorial candidates, Mike Minogue, a former biotech executive, has so far contributed the most: a total of \$5.5 million into his campaign, \$2 million in the

last month alone. Mike Kennealy, a former state economic development secretary also running for governor, has poured \$1.8 million of his own money into his run since the spring. And Brian Shortleeve, a former MBTA executive, put \$200,000 into his campaign in November.

All three are also backed by separate super PACs, which can raise and spend unlimited funds.

John Deaton, the GOP-backed

DONATIONS, Page A7

Immigrant families skipping health care

More no-shows reported; ruling could intensify fear

By Sarah Rahal and Jason Laughlin
GLOBE STAFF

CHELSEA — Health providers across Massachusetts are noticing a troubling ripple effect from stepped-up immigration enforcement: Immigrant families are skipping medical appointments, choosing to forgo care, canceling their limited state-provided health insurance, and weighing health risks against fears of detention or deportation.

Providers worry the situation will worsen because of a Dec. 29 court decision that allows Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents to access personal information Medicaid has on undocumented immigrants. Undocumented immigrants aren't eligible for full Medicaid coverage through the state-run plan, called MassHealth, but they are among 247,500 noncitizens in the state who receive a limited version that covers emergency medical care. ICE now can access many of those records.

"We've seen situations where parents have been deported, and kids are afraid to come," said Cheryl Bartlett, former state public health commissioner and chief executive of the New Bedford Community Health Center. "We've had to think creatively on how to continue to see kids."

Even before the judge's decision, a recent national survey found that 84 percent of health care providers reported decreases in patient visits and more than one-quarter said immigration enforcement was directly affecting patient care.

Two Boston-area mothers who requested anonymity due to their undocumented status said they learned to fear hospitals after people they knew were detained seeking medical help. Both of their children have missed multiple medical appointments as a result.

"I tried to make an appointment for my 8-year-old," said one mother.

HEALTH CARE, Page A6

Prosecutors said to target Fed's Powell

Trump has repeatedly attacked chair over rates

By Glenn Thrush and Colby Smith
NEW YORK TIMES

The US attorney's office in the District of Columbia has opened a criminal investigation into Jerome H. Powell, the Federal Reserve chair, over the central bank's renovation of its Washington headquarters and whether Powell lied to Congress about the scope of the project, according to officials briefed on the situation.

The inquiry, which includes an analysis of Powell's public statements and an examination of spending records, was approved in November by Jeanine Pirro, a longtime ally of President Trump who was appointed to run the office last year, the officials said.

The investigation escalates Trump's long-running feud with Powell, whom the president has continually attacked for resisting his demands to slash interest rates significantly. The president has threatened to fire the Fed chair — even though he nominated Powell for the position in 2017 — and raised the prospect of a lawsuit against him related to the \$2.5 billion renovation, citing "incompetence."

Trump told The New York Times in an interview last week that he had decided on whom he wants to replace Powell as Fed chair. He is expected to soon

POWELL, Page A5



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF



DANIELLE PARHIZKARAN/GLOBE STAFF

PATS PUMMEL CHARGERS

For the first time since their 2019 Super Bowl victory, the New England Patriots won a playoff game, beating the Los Angeles Chargers, 16-3, at Gillette Stadium Sunday night. They were led by a stalwart defense, including linebacker K'Lavon Chaisson (above, after sacking quarterback Justin Herbert). At left, Hunter Henry hauled in a pass for the team's only touchdown. **C1.**

Tragedy ended his life but not family's love

Memories of Umurzokov extend far beyond Brown

By Marcela Rodrigues
GLOBE STAFF

MIDLOTHIAN, Va. — It is the everyday artifacts of his short time at Brown University — a yard sign for the school, the big "B" sticker on his laptop — that MukhammadAziz Umurzokov's family use to hold on to his presence. Inside the beige two-story home in this Richmond suburb, his sisters spend long days in his bedroom, wearing his college hoodies and reminiscing about the brother who took them out to see movies and eat Dave's Hot Chicken.

The 18-year-old freshman was supposed to

UMURZOKOV, Page A7

TINA PACKER 1938-2026

As actor, director, teacher, she offered a more relatable, pulsing Shakespeare

By Don Aucoin
GLOBE STAFF

Tina Packer, the founding artistic director of Lenox's Shakespeare & Company, who exerted a profound influence on the way Shakespeare's works are performed, interpreted, and understood, died Friday evening at 87 of natural causes, according to current Shakespeare & Company artistic director Allyn Burrows.

"It's a very sad day," Burrows said Saturday in a telephone interview. "She was such a life force that it's actually hard to imagine her not being around

PACKER, Page A10



JONATHAN WIGGS/GLOBE STAFF/2001

Ms. Packer cofounded Shakespeare & Company in Lenox in 1978 and her work would eventually include teaching.

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In the news

A crackdown on Iranian demonstrators has left hundreds dead, according to reports from inside the country. **A3.**

"Hamnet" and "One Battle After Another" took the top motion picture awards at the Golden Globes, with "The Pitt" and "The Studio" TV favorites. **C10.**

Prices for PCs and smart-phones are expected to rise as AI boom swallows up computer memory chips. **D1.**

North Atlantic right whales, off a solid breeding season, are pushing back from the brink of extinction. **B1.**

Homeland Security vows to send hundreds more federal agents to Minnesota. **A6.**

Bob Weir dies at 78

The founding member, singer, songwriter, and rhythm guitarist of the Grateful Dead was considered the connective musical tissue of the iconic band. **B6.**



GETTY IMAGES/2023



A shy sol

Monday: Some wind, some sun. High 38-43, low 29-34.

Tuesday: Warmer, high 42-47. Weather and comics, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **B6.**